What is the Qiskit Advocate Mentorship Program (QAMP)?

QAMP is a 3-month mentorship initiative designed to support growth and collaboration within our vibrant open-source community.

Starting **17 Nov**, this program will provide a platform for both mentors and mentees to engage in open-source development or content creation using Qiskit, while building meaningful connections with quantum experts and peers.

Registrations for QAMP 2026 are now open:

- **Mentees** can expect to learn how to contribute to quantum computing advancement. Participants more experienced in open-source development can hone and develop specialized skills. Mentees must be Qiskit advocates.
- **Mentors** can expect to develop leadership and teamwork skills, while making a significant impact on the next generation of quantum developers and leaders.

Participants in previous QAMPs have consistently rated their **experiences over 4.5/5.**

Excited for QAMP 2026?

Propose a project:

1. Open an issue in the QAMP 2026 GitHub repo github.com/qiskit-advocate/qamp-2026
2. Submit the project proposal form

Sign up to be a mentor:

ibm.biz/qamp2026-mentor

Mentors do not need to be Qiskit advocates.

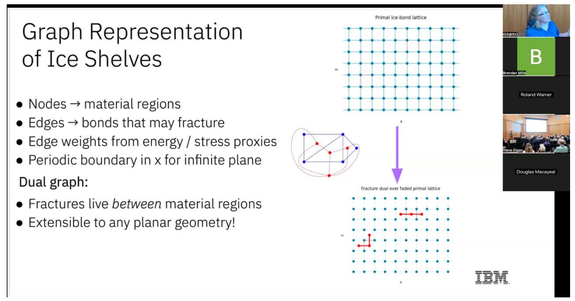
Apply to become a mentee:

Link to the application form is shared in the Qiskit advocate hub on Discord and the advocate-only spaces in the Qiskit Slack workspace (only accessible to Qiskit advocates).

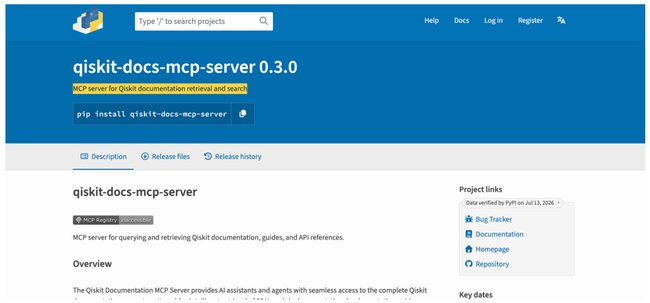
For further questions: Qiskit advocates can ask in the #qap-support channel in the Qiskit advocate hub. External parties can email radha.pyari@ibm.com



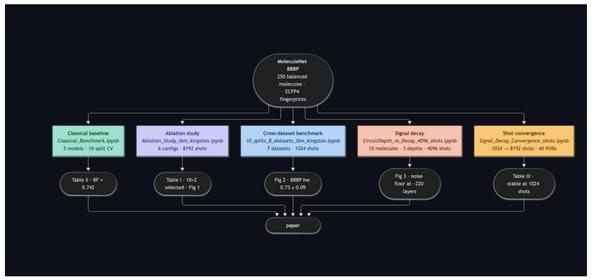
Past QAMP projects



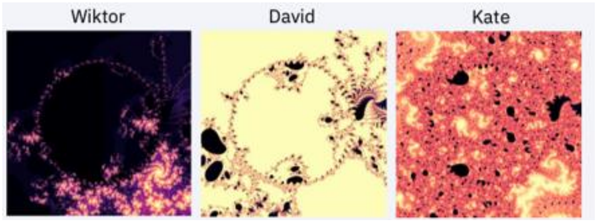
Modeling ice shelf fractures using graph theory and QAOA



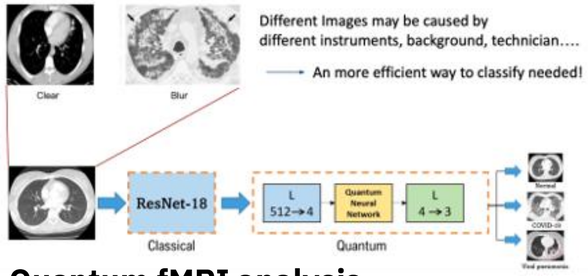
MCP server for Qiskit documentation retrieval and search



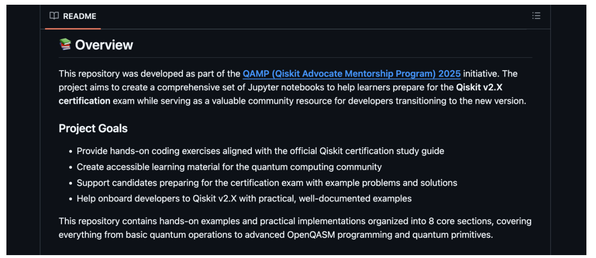
Quantum feature mapping for molecular classification



Quantum fractal art



Quantum fMRI analysis



Comprehensive tutorials for the Qiskit v2.X developer certification exam

QAMP 2025 resulted in:

8+ Qiskit SDK contributions

18+ software packages built on Qiskit

7+ papers (preprint or peer-reviewed)

New educational content from 9 projects; 78% projects run on IBM QPUs

Project interest areas

- Quantum circuits
- Transpilation
- Quantum simulators
- Quantum error correction
- Error suppression & mitigation
- Benchmarking
- Machine learning
- Finance
- Optimization
- Chemistry
- Quantum games/demos
- Technical writing
- Qiskit tutorials
- Education
- Hardware
- UI/UX
- Design
- Open-source community
- Algorithms
- Other

Timeline

Invite to propose problems
End of Oct

Launch
17 Nov

Checkpoint 1
17 Dec
3 min presentation on proposal

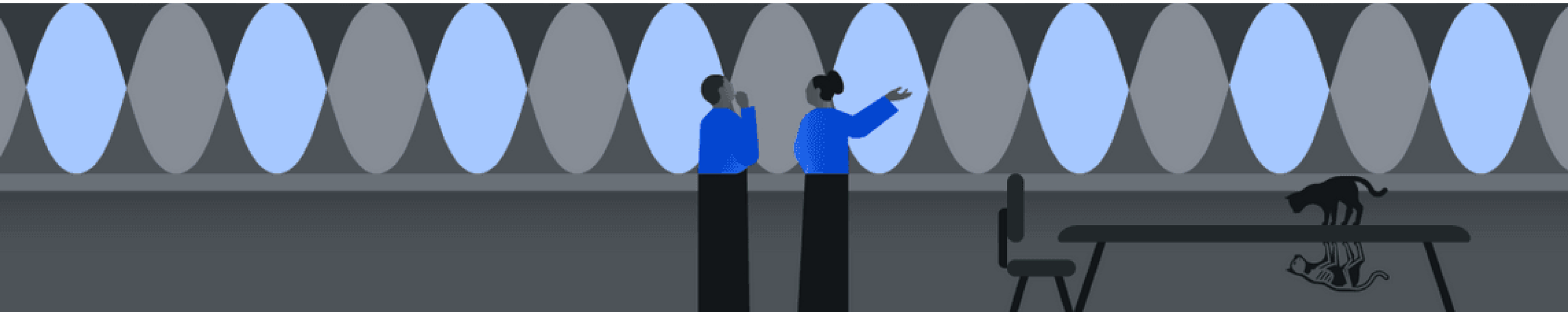
Checkpoint 2
17 Jan
short written report (500 – 1,000 words)

Checkpoint 3
17 Feb

Oct | Nov | Dec | Jan | Feb

Application opens
2 Nov

Final showcase
End of Feb
Final demo



FAQs

For prospective mentors:

Q: By when should I propose a project?
Asap. Prospective mentee applications will be sent to you on a rolling basis from the application call announcement onwards.

Q: What can I expect to gain out of being a QAMP mentor?
- Opportunity to share your knowledge and develop leadership skills
- Learn through teaching
- Opportunity to shape the Qiskit community and future leaders in quantum computing

Q: What is the role of a mentor?
- Help mentees understand core concepts and techniques
- Provide mentees with positive and constructive feedback
- Help mentees find relevant learning/research materials
- Project and people management

Q: What is the expected time commitment?
Being a mentor takes approximately 2-4 hours per week for the duration of the program, plus a couple of hours for the mentee matching process. During the program, you should meet with your mentees at a mutually agreed-upon frequency (recommendation: weekly).

Q: Is this program worth my time?
In the QAMP 2025 survey, **100%** of responding **mentors** agreed or strongly agreed that the program was a **worthwhile use of their time**.

Q: Do I need to be a Qiskit advocate to be a QAMP mentor?
No. Mentors can be:
- Subject matter experts from IBM Quantum or an IBM Quantum Network member who have either worked in the project topic for 3+ years, and/or are currently pursuing or have acquired a higher degree in the field PhD, but who are not Qiskit advocates
- Qiskit advocates at Tier 1 or higher who are subject matter experts in the project topic

Exceptions may be granted in very specific cases, solely at the discretion of QAMP admins.

For prospective mentees:

Q: Do I need to be a Qiskit advocate to be a QAMP mentee?
Yes. Only Qiskit advocates at Tier 1 or higher can join QAMP as mentees. QAMP admins may make exceptions, but only by invitation. Please do not request an exception.

Q: I am a beginner in quantum programming. Can I still participate in QAMP?
Absolutely! Some projects focus on supporting individuals to make their first PR to Qiskit or the Qiskit ecosystem. You may also apply to a project that is less focused on code (e.g., tutorial or blog writing).

Q: What can I expect to gain out of being a QAMP mentee?
- Networking
- Improved skills in project topics
- Published papers or other deliverables
- Professional development experience

Q: What is the expected time commitment?
Time commitment varies across projects and is noted on each project issue. However, we expect QAMP to require approximately 4-8 hours of your time per week.

Q: Is this program worth my time?
In the QAMP 2025 survey, **93.4%** of responding **mentees** agreed or strongly agreed that the program was **worth their time**.



QAMP 2026 GitHub repo:

github.com/qiskit-advocate/qamp-2026